Kalhana’s history is not just about kings and battles but contains an interesting account of how human intervention altered the landscape of Kashmir. He tells of the minister Suyya who carried out a number of major engineering works during the reign of Avantivarman in the ninth century. We are told that landslides and soil erosion had led to a great deal of rubble and stone being deposited in the Jhelum, which was impeding the flow of the river. The rubble was dredged and embankments were built. The landscape was restructured to human use as dams created new lakes while old lakes were drained to clear the way for cultivation. It is even suggested that Suyya may have significantly altered the courses of the Jhelum and Indus rivers.[23] It appears, therefore, that much of the beautiful ‘natural’ landscape of Kashmir may be due to thousands of years of human intervention!